

TravelLuxScents — cPanel Deployment Guide

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Prerequisites

- cPanel access with Python support (Phusion Passenger)
 - SSH access (recommended) or cPanel Terminal
 - Domain configured in cPanel
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Step 1: Upload Files

Option A — SSH/Terminal:

```
cd ~  
git clone <your-repo-url> perfume_decants  
# OR upload via cPanel File Manager
```

Option B — cPanel File Manager:

Upload the project ZIP to `/home/yourusername/` and extract it.

Step 2: Set Up Python Virtual Environment

```
cd ~/perfume_decants  
python3 -m venv venv  
source venv/bin/activate  
pip install --upgrade pip  
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

Step 3: Configure Environment

```
cp .env.example .env  
nano .env # Edit with your actual values
```

Important settings to change:

- `SECRET_KEY` — Generate a new one: `python -c "from django.core.management.utils import get_random_secret_key; print(get_random_secret_key())"`
- `DEBUG=False`
- `ALLOWED_HOSTS=yourdomain.com,www.yourdomain.com`
- Email settings (for order confirmations)
- Stripe keys (when ready)

Step 4: Initialize Database

```
source venv/bin/activate
python manage.py migrate
python manage.py load_sample_data # Loads sample products, quiz, etc.
python manage.py collectstatic --noinput
```

Default admin login: `admin` / `admin123` (CHANGE THIS IMMEDIATELY!)

Step 5: Configure cPanel Python App

1. Go to **cPanel** → **Setup Python App** (or Software → Python)
 2. Click **Create Application**
 3. Set:
 - Python version: 3.12 (or latest available)
 - Application root: `perfume_decants`
 - Application URL: `/` (or your subdomain)
 - Application startup file: `passenger_wsgi.py`
 - Application Entry point: `application`
 4. Click **Create**
-

Step 6: Configure .htaccess

Edit `.htaccess` and replace `yourusername` with your actual cPanel username:

```
PassengerAppRoot /home/YOURUSERNAME/perfume_decants
PassengerPython /home/YOURUSERNAME/perfume_decants/venv/bin/python
```

If your domain's document root is `/home/YOURUSERNAME/public_html/`, copy or symlink:

```
# Option 1: Symlink passenger_wsgi.py to public_html
ln -s ~/perfume_decants/passenger_wsgi.py ~/public_html/passenger_wsgi.py

# Option 2: Copy .htaccess to public_html
cp ~/perfume_decants/.htaccess ~/public_html/.htaccess
```

Step 7: Static & Media Files

If static files aren't served by Django/WhiteNoise, configure Apache aliases:

In cPanel → **Apache Handlers** or via `.htaccess` :

```
Alias /static/ /home/yourusername/perfume_decants/staticfiles/
Alias /media/ /home/yourusername/perfume_decants/media/
```

Ensure proper permissions:

```
chmod -R 755 ~/perfume_decants/staticfiles/  
chmod -R 755 ~/perfume_decants/media/
```

Step 8: Verify & Restart

```
# Restart Passenger  
touch ~/perfume_decants/tmp/restart.txt  
mkdir -p ~/perfume_decants/tmp  
touch ~/perfume_decants/tmp/restart.txt
```

Visit your domain to verify everything works.

Admin Panel

Access at: <https://yourdomain.com/admin/>

From admin you can manage:

- Products, variants, images
- Fragrance notes, badges, longevity options
- Bottle sizes and colors
- Discovery sets
- Quiz questions and recommendations
- Mood collections
- Orders and order statuses
- Site settings (free delivery threshold, WhatsApp number, etc.)
- Trust badges

Troubleshooting

500 Error:

```
# Check error log  
tail -f ~/logs/error.log  
# Or check Python app logs in cPanel
```

Static files not loading:

```
python manage.py collectstatic --noinput  
chmod -R 755 staticfiles/
```

Database issues:

```
python manage.py migrate
# Make sure db.sqlite3 is writable
chmod 664 db.sqlite3
chmod 775 $(dirname db.sqlite3)
```

Restart app after changes:

```
touch ~/perfume_decants/tmp/restart.txt
```

Email Setup (Gmail)

1. Enable 2-Factor Authentication on Gmail
2. Generate an App Password: Google Account → Security → App Passwords
3. Use the app password in `.env` :

```
EMAIL_HOST_USER=your-email@gmail.com
EMAIL_HOST_PASSWORD=your-16-char-app-password
```

Stripe Setup (When Ready)

1. Create account at <https://dashboard.stripe.com>
2. Get API keys from Developers → API Keys
3. Update `.env` :


```
STRIPE_PUBLIC_KEY=pk_live...
STRIPE_SECRET_KEY=sk_live...
```
4. Restart app: `touch ~/perfume_decants/tmp/restart.txt`

Security Checklist

- [] Change `SECRET_KEY` in `.env`
- [] Set `DEBUG=False`
- [] Change admin password
- [] Configure proper `ALLOWED_HOSTS`
- [] Set up HTTPS (SSL certificate via cPanel)
- [] Configure email settings
- [] Secure `.env` file: `chmod 600 .env`